Ship Arrival & Departure Procedures in Libyan Ports

A practical reference for ship owners, charterers and masters calling at Libyan ports — pre-arrival documentation, arrival signalling, berthing, and port restrictions.

01 Pre-Arrival Requirements

Appoint a Local Agent

Before arriving at a Libyan port, ships must appoint a local shipping agent to facilitate communication and compliance with local regulations.

Document Submission 24H BEFORE ETA

The ship owner or agent must submit the following to port management at least 24 hours prior to the Estimated Time of Arrival: completed and signed Forms 1–11, and a copy of Bills of Lading and Cargo Manifest including the weight and volume of the cargo.

Copies of the following certificates:

- International Ship and Port Facility Security (ISPS) Code Certificate
- Radio Safety Certificate
- Classification Society Certificate
- International Load Line Certificate
- International Safety Management (ISM) Code Certificate
- Minimum Safe Manning Certificate
- Ship Sanitation Control Certificate
- Latest Port State Control (PSC) Inspection Report
- Ship Registry Certificate
- Safety Equipment Certificate
- International Oil Pollution Prevention (IOPP) Certificate
- International Tonnage Certificate
- Document of Compliance (DOC)
- Insurance Certificate
- Medical Store List

02 On-Board Required Ship Documents

- Certificate of Registry and Tonnage
- International Shipping Certificate
- International Certificate for the Safety of Life at Sea (SOLAS)
- Crew List (including nationalities)
- Cargo Manifest
- Load Line Certificate
- Passenger Transport Certificate
- Radio and Telex Safety Certificate
- Passenger Manifest (signed-on and signed-off)

03 Arrival Procedures

VHF Channel 16: before entering Libyan territorial waters, the ship must contact port control on VHF Channel 16. **Pilot Boarding:** the ship must not enter the entrance channel until the pilot has boarded. **Health Declaration:** if the master suspects any infectious disease on board, or if the ship has come from a port affected by a pandemic, they must immediately inform the quarantine or port authority upon arrival.

Signalling on approach — the ship must display:

- Call sign
- Ship's flag at the stern
- Red flag by day / red light by night (if carrying explosives or flammables)
- Quarantine flag
- Libyan flag at the bow
- Pilot request signal

Copyright © 2026 Libyan Shipping Agencies Co. All rights reserved.

04 Berthing & Sailing Procedures

> **Master's Responsibilities:** the master must be on the bridge during arrival, departure and while berthed, and must comply with all local and international laws.

Berthing priority (first to arrive, in this order):

- Passenger vessels
- Liner vessels
- Tankers
- Livestock carriers
- General cargo vessels

- **Port Management Authority:** assigns the berth and may relocate the ship for operational efficiency.
- **Anchorage:** ships without a suitable berth may anchor, but must not move without port authority permission.
- **Shifting Berth:** only with port authority permission; the master ensures the new berth's suitability.
- **Compulsory Tug Assistance:** mandatory through tunnels or during shifting operations. **Pilot Services:** a pilot is mandatory for entering or leaving port.
- **Navigation & Liability:** even with a pilot aboard, the master remains responsible for navigation, and the owner is liable for any damage, even if the pilot was at fault.
- **Pilot Fees:** payable even if the entry or departure is cancelled.
- **Cargo Manifest:** must include weight and volume in cubic metres; a copy submitted to the agent 24 hours before arrival.

05 Restrictions & Interdictions

- **Repairs & Maintenance:** none without port authority permission. **Chimney Cleaning:** prohibited while in port. **Lighting:** no lights altered without permission.
- **Waste Disposal:** discharging waste — oil, chemicals or garbage — into the port or territorial waters is strictly prohibited.
- **Currency & Personal Items:** currency, cigarettes and alcohol must be declared.
- **Prohibited Activities:** prostitution, possession of alcohol (except sealed and stored) and unauthorised photography are strictly prohibited.
- **Ship-to-Ship Visits:** require customs and immigration approval.

> For assistance with any stage of your port call, contact Libyan Shipping Agencies Co. — available 24/7. · info@libyanshipping.com · +218 92 318 1930 · Downtown Tower, Al Jama' Al'Ali St., Misrata, Libya

Copyright © 2026 Libyan Shipping Agencies Co. All rights reserved.